

**ZAWAR ALI**  
**SENIOR CONSULTANT-Internal Audit**  
Riyadh, KSA • zawarali147@gmail.com • +(966)-0502468944

---

## PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Internal-audit and compliance specialist with 10 + years in the banking sector across KSA and Pakistan. Proven track record of risk-based audits, regulatory compliance (SAMA, SBP), credit-risk reviews, branch-operations internal controls, fraud investigations and fraud-risk assessments for Tier-1 banks. Skilled at leading cross-functional teams, analyzing complex data (Power BI, SQL, Excel), and presenting clear, actionable findings to Senior Management and Audit Committees. Seeking to drive robust governance and risk culture in a forward-looking financial institution.

---

## KEY SKILLS

Risk-Based Internal Audit | SAMA / SBP Regulations | AML / CFT Compliance | Digital Transformation Fintech Compliance | Shariah Governance | Credit-Risk Assessment (Corporate, SME, Consumer) | Branch-Operations Controls | Fraud-Risk Assessment | Fraud Investigations | Risk Control Self-Assessment (RCSA) | Cards & Payments (VISA, MADA, Mastercard) | Data Analytics (Excel, Power BI, SQL) | Stakeholder Management | Audit Committee Reporting |

---

## PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

### FAMCO ASSOCIATES (ECOVIS AL SABTI, KSA)

Riyadh, KSA

#### Senior Consultant- Internal Audit

Sep-2024 - Present

- Experience of numerous Risk Assessments engagements & Internal audits (Financial, Operational, Compliance, AML CFT and Corporate & Consumer Credit) across the banking sector.
- In-depth understanding of banking regulations and standards (e.g., Saudi Arabian Monetary Authority (SAMA), State Bank of Pakistan (SBP)) impacting operations, compliance, credit etc.
- Extensive experience in auditing the credit risk management framework including policies & procedures for sanctioning and managing Corporate & SME loans.
- Provided actionable recommendations for optimizing processes, operational effectiveness of the controls in place and risk mitigation.
- Drafting internal audit reports following completion of the fieldwork portion of the reviews to concisely and accurately reflect the facts, observations, risks, and recommendations and obtaining management comments thereon. Discussion of audit findings with clients and coordinating the finalization of reports for management review/ final reporting to the Audit Committee.

#### *Specific Projects Experience*

- **Credit Operations & Risk Audit:**
  - Successfully conducted audits of the Real Estate Finance function in line with SAMA guidelines and bank's policies and procedures to evaluate the design and operating effectiveness of the controls in place.
  - Reviewed the credit proposals with respect to loan documents, per party & group exposure limits, industry & financial analysis, and credit committee approvals.
  - Evaluated exception handling procedures, including approvals beyond credit limit, manual disbursements and assessed compensating controls in place to mitigate the risk.

- Reviewed the loan performance parameters of Corporate& SME clients and performed comprehensive analysis on bank's loan portfolio including NPLs.
- **Cards Audit:**
  - Audited credit card customer authentication processes, credit approval decision-making frameworks, quality checks, and exception reporting procedures to ensure compliance with best practices and risk mitigation strategies.
  - Validated daily reconciliations and settlements of VISA, MADA and MasterCard transactions, and identified discrepancies.
  - Analyse the design and implementation of MADA, VISA, and MasterCard Scheme rules, ensuring their effective integration and compliance within the organization's cards business operations.
  - Validated compliance with relevant SAMA regulatory frameworks in the cards business and internal policy requirements, highlighting areas of potential non-compliance or improvements required in operational practices.
- **Compliance & AML Audit:**
  - Successfully conducted audits of the Compliance Function in line with SAMA's Compliance Principles for Banks, evaluating the effectiveness of governance, risk, reporting lines, and operational efficiency of the Compliance Unit.
  - Reviewed Whistleblowing Policy and Program to ensure confidentiality, and non-retaliation mechanisms embedded into the reporting structure and channels.
  - Reviewed the establishment and operational effectiveness of the Self-Supervisory Unit (SSU) in accordance with SAMA's Compliance Principles for Bank.
  - Analysed Tanfeeth Portal compliance processes to assess timely and accurate reporting of compliance-related obligations to SAMA through the Tanfeeth portal.
  - Evaluated the design and effectiveness of the AML policy and procedural manuals, ensuring alignment with regulatory expectations including KYC, customer due diligence (CDD), enhanced due diligence (EDD), and ongoing monitoring.
  - Audited the screening processes for sanctions, PEPs, and watchlists, including real-time and batch screening mechanisms against lists issued by local and international authorities.
  - Reviewed suspicious transaction alerts, validated documentation, and reviewed Suspicious Transaction Reports (STRs) for submission to the Financial Monitoring Unit (FMU).

**UNITED BANK LTD (UBL)**

**Karachi, PK**

**Assistant Manager Compliance Review & Monitoring**

**Jan-2024 – Sep 2024**

- Performed Compliance Reviews of Corporate/Commercial Credit exposures and highlight breaches compared to the relevant SBP PRs and latest circulars.
- Conducting Root Cause Analysis (RCAs) on penalties imposed by the regulator State Bank of Pakistan SBP.
- Carried out Risk Control Self-Assessment exercise on regulatory instructions, mapped the control against them to identify the gaps.
- Review implementation of controls specifically related to regulatory compliance including financial crime/Foreign Exchange/Trade.
- Carried out desktop review of branches to identify areas of regulatory non-compliance and recommended the action plan to rectify it

**NATIONAL BANK OF PAKISTAN (NBP)**

**Karachi, PK**

**Assistant Manager Compliance Review & Monitoring**

**Sep 2022 – Dec 2023**

- Responsible for periodic inspection/Internal Controls Testing of branches within the region to ensure compliance with SBP/NBP applicable policies and procedures.
- To oversee regulatory compliance and ensure adherence to internal control procedures within branch operations.
- Processing of Compliance reports/Clearance certificates of all forms of Audits internal or external.
- Investigate and assess alerts for potential money laundering risks in the bank through FCCM AML software.
- Timely resolution of AML Alerts with proper coordination with head office Compliance team.
- Review all KYC/CDD records i.e. new / existing customers, for accuracy and completeness. Ensure that risk rating is properly assigned to an account.
- Assisting business teams by providing advisory on high-risk accounts for KYC and EDD at the time of on-boarding.

**NATIONAL BANK OF PAKISTAN (NBP)**

**Karachi, PK**

**Branch Operations Manager**

**Feb 2018 – Sep 2022**

- Managing the smooth operations of the branch in compliance with banking regulations / policies and procedures.
- Supervision of all Clearing transaction i.e., Local Inward/Outward Clearing/Intercity Clearing/SC Issuance and encashment of TDRs.
- Plan, direct and control the counter services / branch operations by distribution of work (job rotation) among branch staff through well-defined tasks and responsibilities.
- Approval and authorization of transactions as per approved DOA limit.
- Supervise all ATM related operations including cards operations, ATM replenishment and customer chargeback requests.
- Supervision of issuance and surrender of lockers, monthly balancing and recovery of locker rent & security deposit etc.

**SUMIT BANK LIMITED (SMBL)**

**Karachi, PK**

**Business Support Officer-CAD**

**Sep 2015 – Feb 2018**

- Credit risk review of customer with respect to repayment behavior and bank's credit risk appetite.
- Credit risk and viability of potential and existing clients and establishing their current credit limit.
- Evaluation of Standard Credit Memorandum in the light of internal & external policies for Corporate, Commercial and SME sectors.
- Evaluation of loan applicant's financial Status and ability to repay the loan on the ground of above as well as respective industrial performance.

---

**EDUCATION**

**MBA BANKING & FINANCE**

**Karachi, PK**

**Karachi University Business School**

**2015**

**BACHELOR OF COMMERCE**

**Karachi, PK**

**University of Karachi**

**2012**

## ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

---

- Technical Skills: Advance Excel, Power Bi, My SQL, AML Software (Focal, Napier, FCCM)
- Certifications:
  - Certified Internal Auditor Part I (In Progress)
  - Associate Banker (JAIBP)
  - Advance Excel with Power BI, SQL
- Languages: English, Arabic